

portions on the drum where there is an opposite charge. This is done with lasers, by moving a beam across the drum, it becomes charged and then when the drum is coated with the toner you have a replica of what needs to be printed on the drum. Now the paper is sent in and rolled over the drum and heated. The paper has a much more rougher surface and thus the toner sticks to the paper and not the drum. Laser printers have a higher printing resolution and create printouts of a higher quality. You do have to be careful of touching the printed material as it comes out of the printer as you might smudge the fresh print.

2. Inkjet

Featuring a simpler mechanism the inkjet printers are much cheaper than laser but the print quality also suffers a bit. These printers feature either liquid or solid ink which is then heated and ejected through micropores on the printing head. The printing head moves rapidly to and forth as the paper slides underneath it. These are easier to maintain and clean as compared to laser printers. The method of heating and ejecting ink has evolved over time to such a level that expensive inkjet printers produce the same or even higher quality printouts than cheap laser printers. This might seem to be cost effective at a glance but manufacturers have been sneaky by embedding the print head in the disposable cartridge you are ensured consistent quality at a higher cost. You can subvert the need to be a new cartridge every few months by having your cartridge refilled.

3. 3D

A new entrant into affordable home printers, the 3D printer like the name says produces objects from three dimensional CAD (Computer Aided Design) drawings. Significantly expensive than the other two options and in a league totally different altogether, 3D printers are more of an enthusiast buy. These printers use spools of thin plastic filament as the raw material. The filament is heated up and then laid onto a flat surface layer by layer. Slowly the layers build up and we begin to see the model

